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California man accused of intentionally running over Flock cameras, caught on surveillance

By **Aidin Vaziri**, Staff Writer

July 28, 2026



A Pismo Beach man is accused of damaging at least three Flock Safety license plate readers in Monterey County. Investigators said other surveillance cameras near the devices helped them identify him.

Monterey County Sheriff's Office



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California man accused of intentionally running over Flock cameras, caught on surveillance

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A California man accused of deliberately damaging automated license plate readers was identified using surveillance footage from other cameras near the devices, authorities said Tuesday.

Marcus Bee, 40, of Pismo Beach, was arrested on suspicion of felony vandalism after investigators linked him to damage involving at least three Flock Safety cameras in Monterey County, the county sheriff's office said.

The cameras were in the rural communities of Lockwood and Bradley, about 150 miles south of San Francisco. Authorities said the damage totaled thousands of dollars.

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“Although Bee intentionally damaged the ALPR cameras, his actions were captured by other surveillance cameras located nearby,” the sheriff’s office said in a statement.

Investigators used the recordings and other leads to identify Bee, the agency said.

He was booked into the Monterey County Jail, with bail set at \$30,000.

The sheriff’s office described the damaged devices as public safety infrastructure used to recover stolen vehicles, find missing people and identify vehicles associated with crimes ranging from theft to homicide.

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“This arrest sends a clear message that anyone who intentionally damages

Automated license plate readers photograph passing vehicles and turn license plate numbers and other details — such as a vehicle’s make, model, color, location and the time it was recorded — into searchable information.

Law enforcement agencies across the United States increasingly use the systems to generate investigative leads and receive alerts about vehicles reported stolen or connected to crimes.

Their expansion has also prompted objections from privacy and civil liberties advocates, who argue that broad networks can produce detailed records of people’s movements even when they are not suspected of a crime.

California law requires agencies using automated license plate readers to maintain privacy and security policies and limits how the information may be shared. State and local agencies generally may not share such data with federal or out-of-state law enforcement agencies.

Nieto said damaging the devices would not prevent investigators from continuing to use the technology.

“In this case, the suspect’s own actions were captured on surveillance cameras, leading directly to his arrest,” she said.

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Aidin Vaziri

STAFF WRITER



Aidin Vaziri is a staff writer and pop music critic at the San Francisco Chronicle. His work has appeared in Rolling Stone, National Geographic and MTV.

How to reach Aidin

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